WASEL

Total Addressable Market Analysis

Jordan | Iraq | Egypt

Investor-Ready Market Sizing • February 2026

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Wasel is a subscription-based ride-hailing platform targeting the non-GCC Arab world, beginning in Amman, Jordan. Instead of extracting 25–30% commissions per ride, Wasel charges drivers a flat monthly fee (JD 20–55) and lets them keep 100% of fare revenue. This document presents a rigorous, multi-method TAM/SAM/SOM analysis for Jordan, Iraq, and Egypt — grounded in analyst data from Grand View Research, Astute Analytica, and Statista/Cognitive Market Research, cross-validated with bottom-up unit economics.

Combined 3-Country TAM	Wasel Subscription TAM	5-Year SOM (Year 5)
$2.15B+	**$73M**	**$9.2M**
Ride-hailing gross market (2025)	Driver subscriptions, full penetration	Subscription + ancillary revenue

SECTION 1 — TOP-DOWN ANALYSIS: GLOBAL → MENA → TARGET MARKETS

1.1 Global Ride-Hailing Market

Global market size (2024): ~$150–163 billion in gross ride revenue
Projected CAGR (2025–2030): 8.8–14.4% depending on methodology (see analyst comparison, Section 5)
Global trips: ~11.3 billion completed rides in 2024; 200M+ monthly active users globally

Market Level	2024/2025 Value	CAGR	Source
Global Ride-Hailing Market	$150–163B	8.8–14.4%	*Research & Markets*
Middle East & Africa (MEA) Region	$3.83B (2024) / ~$16B (2025 alt.)	8.7–13.4%	*Cognitive / Astute*

Middle East (ex-Africa)	$4.29B (2023)	13.4%	*Astute Analytica*
GCC Countries (UAE, KSA, Qatar...)	$1.64B (2024)	9.5%	*Cognitive Market Research*
Non-GCC MENA (Jordan + Iraq + Egypt + others)	**~$2.19B (2024, derived)**	**10–12%**	*Derived*
Jordan + Iraq + Egypt (Wasel TAM)	**~$2.15B (2025 est.)**	**9–14%**	*Multi-source*

Note: Global and MEA estimates include GCC premium markets. Wasel deliberately targets non-GCC markets where commission pain is sharpest. The $2.15B figure reflects gross ride-hailing GTV (Gross Transaction Value) across Jordan, Iraq, and Egypt — the market Wasel serves, not what Wasel collects.

1.2 Country-Level TAM (Gross Market)

Country	Market Size (GTV)	CAGR	By 2029/30	Primary Source
Jordan	~$60–75M (2025)	5.2%	$75M (2029)	*Statista*
Iraq	~$115M (2025)	5.1%	$143M (2029)	*Statista*
Egypt	$1.84B (2024) – all services; ~$309–402M e-hailing only	11.4% (Grand View)	$3.61B (2030)	*Grand View Research*
COMBINED (3-Market Total)	**~$2.15B**	**9–14%**	**~$4.0B+**	*Multi-source*

Key Note on Egypt Variance: Estimates range from $309M (Statista, e-hailing only) to $1.84B (Grand View, includes car sharing + rental). For conservative modeling, Wasel uses $400–500M as the addressable e-hailing sub-segment for Egypt in Year 3.

SECTION 2 — BOTTOM-UP ANALYSIS: UNIT ECONOMICS × DRIVER POPULATION

Wasel's revenue comes exclusively from driver subscriptions, not fare percentages. This fundamentally changes the TAM calculation: Wasel's addressable market is the pool of ride-hailing drivers × the subscription fee they pay, not the gross value of rides completed.

2.1 Driver Population Estimates

Market	Licensed App Drivers	Informal / Unlicensed Est.	Wasel Addressable	Source / Basis

Jordan (all cities)	11,600 (LTRC official) Uber & Careem: 6,000 each	50,000+ (Parliamentary estimate)	**20,000–25,000**	*ARIJ / LTRC (2025)*
Iraq (Baghdad, Erbil, Basra, Najaf)	Careem: 4 cities; Uber: major cities Est. 15,000–20,000 formal	Large informal sector; 80,000+ taxi-type workers	**35,000–50,000**	*Careem Iraq (2024) + author est.*
Egypt (Cairo, Alexandria, Giza)	Uber, Careem, Halan, InDrive, Bolt Est. 150,000–250,000 active	Millions of informal workers; massive city of 21M+	**150,000–200,000**	*Grand View / author est.*

2.2 Subscription Revenue TAM (Bottom-Up)

Wasel's blended subscription rate is JD 32/month in Jordan (average of Starter/Core/Pro mix, assuming 40%/40%/20% distribution). Price points are adjusted downward for Iraq and Egypt given lower per-capita incomes.

Market	Addressable Drivers	Avg. Monthly Sub.	Annual Sub. TAM	Assumptions
Jordan	22,000	JD 32 (~$45)	**$11.9M**	Mid of official 11,600 + partial informal; blended JD 32 per Wasel model
Iraq	42,000	~$30	**$15.1M**	Conservative; Iraq GDP/capita ~$5,500; price set at 65% of Jordan tier
Egypt	170,000	~$25	**$51.0M**	Egypt GDP/capita ~$3,500; massive informal sector; conservative penetration
TOTAL SUBSCRIPTION TAM	234,000 drivers	—	**$78.0M / yr**	Subscriptions only; excludes Year 2+ ancillary streams

With ancillary revenue (Year 2+: insurance brokerage, B2B corporate accounts, data licensing, in-app ads, fleet management), the total economic opportunity multiplies by ~1.4–1.6×, placing the full Wasel platform TAM at $105–125M across all three markets at scale.

SECTION 3 — TAM / SAM / SOM BREAKDOWN

Tier	Definition	Dollar Figure	What It Represents	Basis
TAM	Total Addressable Market — everyone	**$2.15B (gross GTV) $78M (subscriptions)**	All ride-hailing drivers + riders in Jordan, Iraq,	*Top-down (Statista, Grand View)* +

	who could theoretically use Wasel		Egypt. The $78M is Wasel's revenue-layer TAM.	*bottom-up unit economics*
SAM	Serviceable Addressable Market — drivers in cities Wasel will operate in	**$1.2B (gross GTV) $48M (subscriptions)**	Amman, Irbid, Zarqa, Aqaba (Jordan) + Baghdad, Erbil, Basra (Iraq, Yr 3) + Cairo, Alexandria, Giza (Egypt, Yr 3–5). ~75–85% of each country market.	*City-level population weighting applied to country TAM*
SOM	Serviceable Obtainable Market — realistic Year 5 capture	**$9.2M (Year 5 revenue)**	13,966 EoY active drivers at blended JOD 39.19/month by Y5 (tier-mix shift), plus Year 2+ ancillary (JD 991K). Requires reaching 8 markets by Year 5.	*Cohort-based driver model; net income positive Year 2; cumulative payback Year 3; break-even at ~1,000–1,200 M2+ drivers*

3.1 Jordan Deep Dive — Launch Market

Metric	Figure	Notes
Official licensed smart-app vehicles	11,600	LTRC (Jordan Land Transport Regulatory Commission), 2025
Uber + Careem license allocation	6,000 each (12,000 combined)	Near-duopoly; ARIJ investigative report (Nov 2025)
Estimated unlicensed app drivers	50,000+	Per Jordanian Parliament + Smart Apps Drivers Committee
Avg. gross driver monthly revenue (Careem/Uber)	JD 585/month	JD 2.50 avg fare × 9 trips/day × 26 days — per Wasel model assumptions
Platform commission paid (30%)	JD 175.50/month	Extracted by Uber/Careem from every fare; 30% of JD 585
Wasel flat fee (blended, all tiers)	JD 32.25/month ($45.47 USD)	45% Starter (JD 20) / 35% Core (JD 35) / 20% Pro (JD 55) — model-derived tier mix
Monthly savings per driver	**JD 143.25 (−81.6% cost reduction)**	Transformative in a low-wage economy (avg. Jordanian salary ~JD 500–600)
Jordan subscription TAM (annual)	**$11.9M**	22,000 drivers × $45.47/month × 12
Wasel break-even threshold	**~1,000–1,200 active M2+ drivers**	~5–6% of the licensed market; break-even confirmed via stress-test modelling

SECTION 4 — 5-YEAR GROWTH PROJECTIONS

4.1 Market CAGR Assumptions by Country

Country	Conservative CAGR	Base CAGR	Upside CAGR	Key Drivers
Jordan	5.0%	8.0%	11.0%	Regulatory expansion of licenses; informal market formalization
Iraq	8.0%	12.0%	18.0%	Young population (60%+ under 30); oil revenue rebuilding cities; low penetration base
Egypt	9.0%	11.4%	14.3%	Population 106M; Cairo 21M; high smartphone penetration; Bolt entry (2024) validates market
Wasel Revenue CAGR (Years 1–5)	Conservative	Base Case	**154% (Base)**	Model-derived from 250-driver Amman seed; 30% MoM growth; 8-market geographic expansion to Y5. Ramp-year effect amplifies early CAGR.

4.2 Wasel Revenue Projections — Base Case

Methodology: Starts with 250 seed drivers in Amman (Month 1), growing at 30% MoM compounded through a graduated onboarding funnel (25% M0→M1 churn, 12% M1→M2 churn, 4%/mo early active, 2%/mo mature). Revenue begins from Month 2 when M1 ramp drivers pay JD 10. Full tier pricing activates from M2+. Multi-year expansion follows the geographic roadmap (3 Jordan cities by Y2, Iraq by Y3, Egypt Y4–5) driving non-linear driver growth. All figures in JOD; USD at 1 JOD = $1.41.

Metric	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Year 4	Year 5
Active Markets	Amman only	All 4 Jordan cities	Jordan + Baghdad, Erbil	+ Basra + Cairo	8 markets (Jordan + Iraq + Egypt)
EoY Active Drivers	1,479	3,254	6,020	9,632	13,966
Avg Active Drivers (Annual)	1,112	2,367	4,637	7,826	11,799
Blended Monthly Fee (JOD)	JD 32.25	JD 33.86	JD 36.23	JD 38.04	JD 39.19
Subscription Revenue (JOD)	JD 157,261	JD 961,830	JD 2,016,142	JD 3,572,837	JD 5,548,247

Ancillary Revenue (JOD)	—	JD 28,404	JD 139,110	JD 422,604	JD 991,116
TOTAL REVENUE (JOD)	**JD 157,261**	**JD 990,234**	**JD 2,155,252**	**JD 3,995,441**	**JD 6,539,363**
TOTAL REVENUE (USD equiv.)	**$221K**	**$1.40M**	**$3.04M**	**$5.63M**	**$9.22M**
YoY Revenue Growth	—	**+530%**	**+118%**	**+85%**	**+64%**
EBITDA (JOD)	(JD 789,667)	**JD 120,964**	**JD 887,804**	**JD 2,236,917**	**JD 4,225,115**
EBITDA Margin	(502%)	12.2%	41.2%	56.0%	64.6%
Net Income (JOD)	(JD 801,334)	**JD 107,547 ✓**	JD 873,045	JD 2,220,977	JD 4,208,378
Cumulative Net Income (JOD)	(JD 801,334)	(JD 693,787)	**JD 179,259 ✓**	JD 2,400,236	JD 6,608,614

5-Year Revenue CAGR (Base Case): ~154% (JOD) | Note: Year 1 is the ramp year (Amman only, 250 seed drivers). Y1→Y2 growth (+530%) reflects multi-city Jordan expansion. Y2–Y5 growth normalizes to 64–118% as the model matures. Net income turns positive in Year 2; cumulative payback achieved in Year 3.

SOM Penetration at Year 5: 13,966 EoY drivers across 8 markets, generating JD 6.54M ($9.22M USD). This represents ~11.8% of the $78M combined-market subscription TAM and ~12% of the Jordan+Iraq+Egypt SAM.

SECTION 5 — COMPARISON: THREE ANALYST REPORTS

Research Firm	Report Focus	Key Market Size	CAGR	Methodology	Wasel Relevance
Astute Analytica (Jul 2024)	Middle East Ride-Hailing Services Market 2024–2032	$4.29B (2023) $12.40B by 2032	13.4% CAGR	Top-down with country segmentation; includes GCC premium markets	Sets optimistic MENA ceiling; Wasel targets non-GCC subset where growth is structurally driven by cost pressure, not luxury
Grand View Research (2024–2025)	Egypt Ride Hailing Service Market	$1.84B (2024) $3.61B by 2030	11.4% CAGR	Bottom-up + interviews; covers car sharing, e-hailing, rental segments	Egypt is Wasel's Year 3 target. Bolt's 2024 entry validates competitive demand. E-hailing sub-segment (~$400–500M) is Wasel's true Egypt TAM.

Statista / Cognitive Market Research (2024–2025)	Ride-hailing by country: Jordan, Iraq, Egypt, MEA region	Jordan: $60–75M Iraq: $115–143M Egypt: $309–402M MEA: $3.83B	5.1–8.7% (Statista) 8.7% (Cognitive MEA)	Statista: consumer survey + platform transaction data; most conservative estimates; excludes informal sector	Most relevant for Jordan/Iraq micro-sizing. Conservative baseline for investor credibility. Excludes 50,000+ informal Jordan drivers — Wasel's primary supply pool.

Analyst Reconciliation: Why Estimates Vary

The wide variance across analyst estimates (e.g., Egypt at $309M vs $1.84B) reflects methodological differences: Statista captures only digitally-booked rides by formal platforms (excluding cash transactions and informal drivers), while Grand View and Astute Analytica include car-sharing, rentals, and informal mobility. For Wasel's purposes, the truth lies between these poles. Wasel's supply-side TAM (driver subscriptions) is most accurately modeled using bottom-up driver population data cross-referenced with Statista country-level metrics as a floor.

Jordan's 50,000+ informal drivers (per Parliament testimony) represent Wasel's most compelling early market: a documented, frustrated supply base that no existing platform is adequately serving.

SECTION 6 — KEY ASSUMPTIONS & RISK FACTORS

6.1 Core Modeling Assumptions

Assumption	Value Used	Rationale
Blended subscription fee (Jordan launch)	JD 32/month ($45 USD)	40% Starter / 40% Core / 20% Pro distribution; natural tier progression assumed
Churn rate (post-ramp phase)	8–12% annually	Insurance lock-in (3rd-party liability in base tier) creates structural switching cost; Careem Jordan historically had 90%+ retention
CAC (Customer Acquisition Cost)	$15–25 per driver (Jordan); $20–35 (Iraq/Egypt)	Referral-heavy growth expected in close-knit driver communities; no rider marketing in Year 1
LTV:CAC Ratio	13.9x	Per Wasel unit economics model: blended contribution margin / mo × avg driver lifespan (months) ÷ fully-loaded CAC of JD 45 (~$63 USD)
Jordan license quota (regulatory risk)	11,600 formal vehicles (LTRC cap)	Wasel strategy: serve licensed market first; lobby for license

		expansion; also recruit informal drivers willing to formalize
Exchange rate (JOD/USD)	1 JOD = $1.41 USD (pegged)	JOD is USD-pegged; no FX risk in Jordan. Iraq uses IQD (1 USD ≈ 1,310 IQD). Egypt EGP floated — pricing in EGP with USD floor.
Rider-side growth requirement	Passive initially; co-benefit of driver quality	Wasel's driver value proposition (savings, insurance) creates more motivated, professional drivers — which organically attracts riders from Uber/Careem

6.2 Principal Risks

Risk	Severity	Mitigation
License quota constraint (Jordan LTRC)	HIGH	Partner with LTRC to demonstrate formalization of informal drivers; position Wasel as regulatory compliance tool, not competitor to status quo. Target informal drivers first as subscriber base then advocate for their formal license.
Uber/Careem pricing retaliation	MEDIUM	Wasel's fixed-cost model is structurally immune to commission cuts — a race to the bottom on fares only hurts commission platforms more. Insurance bundle creates non-price lock-in.
Iraq security and infrastructure risk	MEDIUM	JV structure with local Iraqi partner absorbs regulatory, security, and operational complexity. Careem's success in Baghdad, Najaf, Basra, Erbil proves market viability.
Egypt EGP currency devaluation	MEDIUM	USD floor pricing for subscriptions. Egypt entry deferred to Year 3+, allowing monitoring of macroeconomic stability.
Driver supply-demand imbalance at launch	LOW-MED	Free trial month + discounted ramp (JD 10/month) onboarding eliminates initial financial barrier. Soft dispatch cap creates natural monetization pressure without hard churn trigger.

SECTION 7 — INVESTOR SUMMARY

The Market Case for Wasel

- Jordan, Iraq, and Egypt represent a $2.15B+ gross ride-hailing market growing at 9–14% CAGR
- 234,000 addressable ride-hailing drivers collectively pay $280–420M/year to commission platforms
- Wasel's subscription TAM: $78M/year (subscriptions alone) — a defensible, low-competition niche within a high-growth macro market

Why This Market, Why Now

- Jordan: 50,000+ unlicensed drivers exist, proving demand outstrips current supply structure
- Jordan's official license duopoly (Uber + Careem hold 92% of licenses) leaves a structural opening for a driver-first alternative
- Egypt: Bolt's 2024 launch (with 50% rider discounts + 0% commission) validates driver willingness to switch

- Break-even at ~1,000–1,200 M2+ drivers (model-validated); 13,966 drivers by Year 5 is ~11.8% of combined SAM
- LTV:CAC of 13.95x with 2.55-month payback and insurance-driven retention moat

— Wasel's permanent model is structurally superior to Bolt's promotional entry

- Iraq: Oil economy rebuild + youthful population + low penetration = highest growth CAGR in portfolio
- Cash-first infrastructure (65% cash in Jordan) matches Wasel's model vs Uber/Careem's digital-first requirement

Wasel doesn't compete with Uber on luxury features. It competes on a single, devastating economic proposition: the platform that takes 30% versus the platform that takes $45 flat. In markets where that 30% means the difference between a living wage and poverty — there is no competition.

SOURCES & CITATIONS

#	Source	Data Point Used	Date / URL
1	**Astute Analytica**	Middle East ride-hailing: $4.29B (2023) → $12.40B (2032), CAGR 13.4%	*Jul 2024 — astuteanalytica.com*
2	**Grand View Research**	Egypt market: $1.84B (2024) → $3.61B (2030), CAGR 11.4%; e-hailing fastest at 14.1%	*2024–2025 — grandviewresearch.com*
3	**Statista Market Forecast**	Jordan: $60–75M by 2029 (5.22% CAGR); Iraq: $143M by 2029 (5.1%); Egypt: $527M by 2029	*2024–2025 — statista.com*
4	**Cognitive Market Research**	MEA ride-hailing: $3.83B (2024), CAGR 8.7%; GCC: $1.64B; Egypt: $402M	*Oct 2025 — cognitivemarketresearch.com*
5	**Research & Markets**	Global: $150.35B (2024) → $163.55B (2025), CAGR 8.8%	*2025 — researchandmarkets.com*
6	**ARIJ (Arab Reporters for Investigative Journalism)**	Jordan: 11,600 licensed vehicles; 50,000+ unlicensed drivers; license duopoly (Uber+Careem = 12,000)	*Nov 2025 — en.arij.net*
7	**POMEPS (Project on Middle East Political Science)**	Jordan: 11,000 Careem drivers (2018); 5,500 mid-2019; 90%+ retention; driver earnings JD 560/month (part-time)	*Jan 2022 — pomeps.org*
8	**Careem (official)**	Iraq operations: Baghdad, Najaf, Basra, Erbil; goal of 10,000+ jobs in Basra alone	*2024 — careem.com/iraq-rides*
9	**Industry Research Biz**	MEA: $16B (2025 alt. estimate); Egypt: $1.92B (2025)	*2025 — industryresearch.biz*

10	**Wikipedia / Careem**	Uber acquired Careem ($3.1B, 2019); e& acquired Careem Super App (2023, $400M); EV fleet Jordan (45% in Irbil, 2023)	*2024 — en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Careem*